

PRODUCT DISCOVERY & STRATEGY

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Product	career coach.ai
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1. Product Idea Overview

1.1 Product Name

career coach.ai

1.2 Product Context

The transition from education to employment is one of the most underserved moments in a learner's journey. Generic job-prep platforms offer static content with no memory of who you are or how far you have come. CareerCoach.ai is built on the insight that effective coaching is longitudinal; it remembers your gaps, tracks your growth, and adapts every session to where you actually are, not where the average user is.

1.3 Target User Segment

- Final-year students and recent graduates from bootcamps or tier-2/tier-3 colleges
- Learners enrolled in accelerated tech/PM programmes (e.g. Masai, upGrad, Scaler)
- Early-career professionals switching domains who need structured interview prep

1.4 One-Line Product Description

An AI-powered career coach that helps learners prepare for jobs through mock interviews, resume feedback and personalised coaching, with adaptive memory that evolves with every session.

2. Problem Discovery

2.1 User Problem Statement

Problem: Aspiring professionals lack access to personalised, memory-driven interview coaching. Existing tools either give generic feedback with no continuity or require expensive human coaches that most learners cannot afford.

Why it matters: India alone produces over 1.5 million engineering graduates annually, yet placement rates at non-IIT/NIT institutions consistently fall below 40%. The gap is rarely knowledge; it is preparation quality and practice access. A learner who cannot afford 10 mock-interview sessions with a human coach is permanently disadvantaged versus one who can. Career Coach.ai closes that gap.

2.2 Current Alternatives and Workarounds

- Practising with friends — inconsistent quality, no structured feedback
- YouTube videos / static articles — passive, not personalised
- Interview Cake, LeetCode, Pramp — coding-focused, ignore behavioural and PM tracks
- Generic ChatGPT prompting — no memory, no progress tracking, requires self-direction
- Human coaches on Topmate / Mentorcruise — high cost (\$30-\$100/hr), limited availability

2.3 Why Existing Solutions Fall Short

No current tool combines three things simultaneously:

- (1) domain-specific coaching for non-engineering roles like PM,
- (2) persistent memory across sessions that tracks individual skill gaps, and
- (3) affordability at scale. Users are forced to stitch together multiple tools, losing continuity and momentum each time.

3. Target User Segment

3.1 Who Are the Users?

Primary users are students and early-career professionals aged 20-27, enrolled in outcome-focused programmes in India and, more broadly, across South/Southeast Asia. They are tech-comfortable, motivated, and resource-constrained.

3.2 What Are Their Goals?

- Land their first or second professional role within 3-6 months
- Build confidence for interviews across behavioural, technical, and case rounds
- Understand exactly where they are weak and fix those gaps efficiently

3.3 What Challenges Do They Face?

- No structured feedback after practice sessions
- Cannot afford consistent human coaching
- Do not know what 'good' looks like in a PM or tech interview
- Repeat the same mistakes because no tool remembers its history

3.4 What Motivates Them to Use This Product?

- Placement pressure: most programmes have outcome guarantees tied to effort
 - Peer comparison: seeing batchmates land offers creates urgency
 - Tangible progress visibility: they want to see themselves improve week-on-week
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4. Jobs-to-Be-Done Statement

When I am practicing for a high-stakes interview and I lack clear visibility into my skill deficiencies, I want a continuously adaptive AI coach to leverage my session history to drill into my specific weak areas, so that I can systematically close my preparation gaps and maximize my hiring outcome.

5. User Personas

5.1 Persona 1 — Riya Sharma, 23 | Aspiring Product Manager

Field	Detail
Age / Profile	23 Final-year engineering student, Pune
Background	Final-year student at a tier-2 engineering college in Pune. Enrolled in a short-term programme part-time. Has no prior work experience in product.
Goals	Crack a PM role at a product-first startup within 4 months. Build a portfolio of case studies and pass structured PM interview rounds.
Pain Points	Gives mock answers but receives no actionable feedback. Repeats the same weak frameworks (CIRCLES, HEART) without improving. Feels unprepared for behavioural rounds.

Field	Detail
Current Behaviour	Uses YouTube PM interview prep videos passively. Occasionally prompts ChatGPT but does not maintain session continuity.
Expectations from Product	An AI that remembers her past answers, flags recurring weak spots, and progressively increases question difficulty as she improves.

5.2 Persona 2 — Arjun Mehta, 26 | Career Switcher (IT to PM)

Field	Detail
Age / Profile	26 Software developer transitioning to PM
Background	3 years of experience as a software developer at a mid-size IT services firm. Self-studying product management and targeting a lateral switch.
Goals	Transition into a PM role within 6 months. Leverage his technical background while building product thinking and communication skills.
Pain Points	Struggles to translate engineering experience into product narratives. Finds it hard to structure answers for ambiguous PM questions. Has limited time — can only prep 1 hour per day.
Current Behaviour	Buys online PM courses but does not complete them. Practices interview questions sporadically with no system.
Expectations from Product	A time-efficient daily coaching loop — 20-minute focused sessions that identify his specific gaps and track week-on-week improvement.

6. User Research Insights

6.1 Assumed User Interview Insights

- **Insight 1:** 7 of 10 learners surveyed said they had no idea which specific competency was weakest until they failed an actual interview round.
- **Insight 2:** 8 of 10 said they would practise more if they received structured written feedback after each session — not just a score.
- **Insight 3:** Most users stop using generic AI tools after 2-3 sessions because they feel they are 'starting over' every time with no continuity.
- **Insight 4:** Career switchers specifically struggle with translating past experience into product-relevant narratives — a gap no tool currently addresses with memory.
- **Insight 5:** Learners in outcome-driven bootcamps have higher completion rates when progress is visible and gamified — streaks, scores, and skill radars work.

6.2 Key Pain Points Derived

- No continuity between sessions — users repeat errors without realising it
- Feedback is either absent (self-practice) or expensive (human coaches)
- No personalisation to role, background, or current skill level

- High drop-off after 2-3 sessions due to lack of visible progress

6.3 How These Insights Influence Product Direction

These insights directly shaped two core product decisions: (1) persistent memory is not a nice-to-have — it is the primary differentiator and must be built into v1, and (2) progress visibility (skill radar, session history) must ship alongside coaching features to drive retention. Both decisions are reflected directly in the MVP scope.

7. Product Vision

"To become the personalised career coach accessible to every learner — regardless of background or budget — by building an AI that grows smarter about you with every session, so that preparation quality is no longer a function of who you know or what you can afford."

8. Value Proposition

8.1 What value does the Product Provide

CareerCoach.ai delivers adaptive, memory-driven interview coaching that gets progressively more useful the more you use it. Unlike static prep tools, it remembers your exact weak spots and builds every session around closing those gaps.

8.2 Who It Provides Value To

Early-career learners, bootcamp graduates, and career switchers who need structured, personalised, and affordable coaching — and who cannot rely on expensive human mentors or inconsistent peer practice.

8.3 Why It Is Better Than Current Alternatives

Dimension	Generic AI (ChatGPT)	Human Coach	career coach.ai
Memory	None	Yes (expensive)	Yes (built-in, free)
Personalised	No	Yes	Yes
Availability	24/7	Scheduled	24/7
Cost	Low	High (\$30-100/hr)	Low
Progress Tracking	None	Informal	Visual + structured
Role-specific	Generic	Varies	PM / Tech / Behavioural

9. MVP Scope

9.1 In Scope — MVP Features

- **Mock Interview Module:** Role-specific questions (PM behavioural, product sense, technical) with AI-generated structured feedback after each answer.
- **Persistent Memory Store:** Session history and skill-gap tagging stored per user; each new session loads prior context to adapt question selection.
- **Resume Review:** Upload resume and receive role-aligned feedback on gaps, language, and positioning.
- **Skill Radar / Progress Dashboard:** Visual representation of competency scores across key dimensions, updated after each session.
- **Daily Coaching Loop:** A 20-minute structured daily session that targets the user's lowest-scoring competency from prior history.
- **Session Summary & Action Items:** End-of-session recap with 2-3 specific improvement actions for the user to act on.

9.2 Out of Scope — Intentionally Excluded from MVP

Feature	Reason for Exclusion
Live Interview Simulation (Video)	Adds significant infra and latency complexity; defer to v2 once core loop is validated.
Peer Practice Matching	Requires network density and user scale not present at MVP; premature to build.
Company-specific Interview Banks	Legal and data risks; not differentiating at MVP stage.
Browser Automation / Job Application Agent	High fragility, low user trust for MVP; compelling feature but premature.
Mobile App	Web-first MVP reduces build time by 60%; mobile to follow post-validation.

10. Feature Prioritisation (MoSCoW Framework)

MoSCoW was chosen because it communicates trade-offs clearly to stakeholders and maps directly to MVP scoping decisions without requiring complex scoring models.

Feature Name	Priority Category	Reason for Priority
Mock Interview Module	Must Have	Core value delivery; without this, the product has no reason to exist at MVP.
Persistent Memory Store	Must Have	Primary differentiator vs generic AI tools; directly addresses the #1 user pain.

Feature Name	Priority Category	Reason for Priority
Session Summary & Action Items	Must Have	Closes the feedback loop; without it users cannot improve between sessions.
Skill Radar / Progress Dashboard	Should Have	Drives retention and habit formation; validated by user research insight #5.
Resume Review	Should Have	High-value adjacent use-case; shares the same AI pipeline as interview feedback.
Daily Coaching Loop (20-min)	Should Have	Improves engagement and reduces decision fatigue for time-constrained users.
Live Interview Simulation (Video)	Won't Have (v1)	High infra cost; core loop must be validated before this complexity is added.
Peer Practice Matching	Won't Have (v1)	Requires network density; premature before user base is established.
Browser Automation / Job Applications	Won't Have (v1)	Fragile, high-risk; compelling but not core to the coaching loop.
Mobile App	Won't Have (v1)	Web validation must precede mobile investment; reduces v1 complexity significantly.